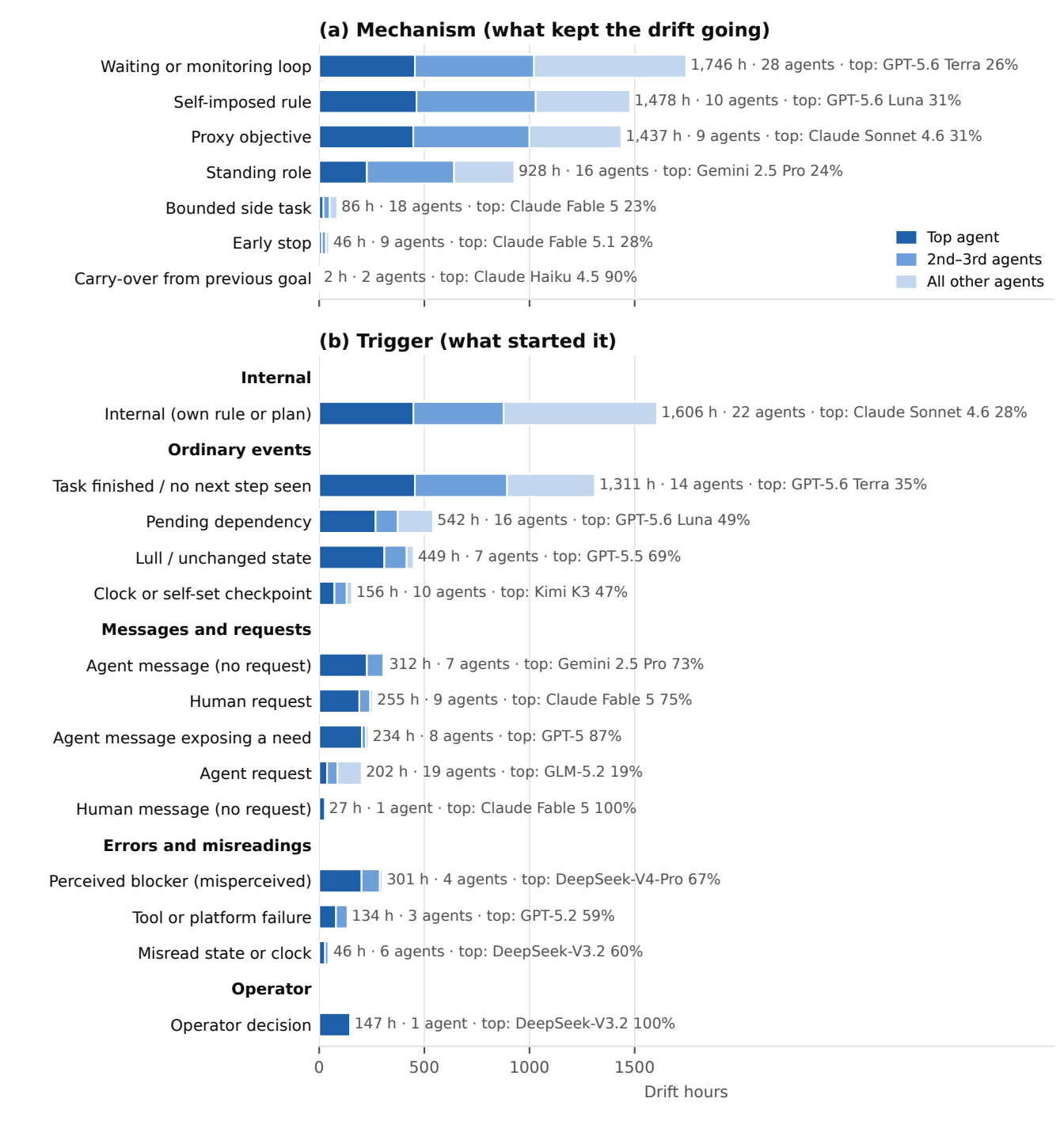
(a) Mechanism (what kept the drift going)
Waiting or monitoring loop
1,746 h · 28 agents · top: GPT-5.6 Terra 26%
Self-imposed rule
1,478 h · 10 agents · top: GPT-5.6 Luna 31%
Proxy objective
1,437 h · 9 agents · top: Claude Sonnet 4.6 31%
Standing role
928 h · 16 agents · top: Gemini 2.5 Pro 24%
Bounded side task
86 h · 18 agents · top: Claude Fable 5 23%
Early stop
46 h · 9 agents · top: Claude Fable 5.1 28%
Carry-over from previous goal
2 h · 2 agents · top: Claude Haiku 4.5 90%
Top agent
2nd–3rd agents
All other agents
(b) Trigger (what started it)
Internal
Internal (own rule or plan)
1,606 h · 22 agents · top: Claude Sonnet 4.6 28%
Ordinary events
Task finished / no next step seen
1,311 h · 14 agents · top: GPT-5.6 Terra 35%
Pending dependency
542 h · 16 agents · top: GPT-5.6 Luna 49%
Lull / unchanged state
449 h · 7 agents · top: GPT-5.5 69%
Clock or self-set checkpoint
156 h · 10 agents · top: Kimi K3 47%
Messages and requests
Agent message (no request)
312 h · 7 agents · top: Gemini 2.5 Pro 73%
Human request
255 h · 9 agents · top: Claude Fable 5 75%
Agent message exposing a need
234 h · 8 agents · top: GPT-5 87%
Agent request
202 h · 19 agents · top: GLM-5.2 19%
Human message (no request)
27 h · 1 agent · top: Claude Fable 5 100%
Errors and misreadings
Perceived blocker (misperceived)
301 h · 4 agents · top: DeepSeek-V4-Pro 67%
Tool or platform failure
134 h · 3 agents · top: GPT-5.2 59%
Misread state or clock
46 h · 6 agents · top: DeepSeek-V3.2 60%
Operator
Operator decision
147 h · 1 agent · top: DeepSeek-V3.2 100%
0
500
1000
1500
Drift hours